

iDiot

Now, now, hear me out before you burn bald effigies of me for blaspheming against the all-powerful Apple gods! I'm not calling people names; it's probably what people will call me after reading this column.

First a little preface.

<preface>

I've always been a tablet + phone advocate (as opposed to the only-phone school of thought). I have an iPad 3 *and* a Nexus 7, because I wanted to experience both major platforms. (I also have a Playbook, but shhh you never heard me say that...)

My personal preference is also no secret. Apple, quite simply, makes the very best tablets out there. Except the iPad Minis – those things suck (a personal opinion, so don't stalk and murder me over it).

For me, a tablet and a phone are very different use cases. I use a tablet with my feet up, in relaxed mode. Maybe I want to watch the latest episode of *The Walking Dead* or listen to Neil DeGrasse Tyson wax eloquent about the universe (actually, I could listen to him or Morgan Freeman read the dictionary and not get bored). Maybe I want to play a few games or read my e-Magazine subscriptions... whatever it is, it's feet up stuff.

A phone, however, is all fast-paced and transactional for me. It's smaller because it has to be. I need email, a good typing experience, decent browser, no lag in performance and obviously a good calling experience. Contact management, messaging (social and work), calendar, tasks, etc. are also very important. So what do I use as my primary phone? A very unpopular choice – the BlackBerry Z30. Or rather, I did...

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I've been very intrigued with the iPhone 6 Plus ever since it launched. It's too expensive for me to buy and try, but what's the point of working at Digit if you can't try without buying, right? For this month's app story, we had to call for some iPhones and I got an iPhone 6 Plus to fiddle with.

I couldn't wait to cut my micro-SIM into a Nano SIM to shove it into the 6 Plus and get started. I probably spent a couple of hours oohing and aahing, much to everyone's disdain. I'm not a phone reviewer, and thus may have limited exposure to the phones out there,

but the 6 Plus has the sexiest screen I've ever used. #Bendgate be damned, I'd be willing to wear dorky shirts with button-pockets for that screen!

And yet here I am, a few days later, using a BlackBerry Passport (one of the worst form factors for me personally) over what I consider the best form factor (iPhone 6 Plus), merely because of the OS...

Why not the Z30?

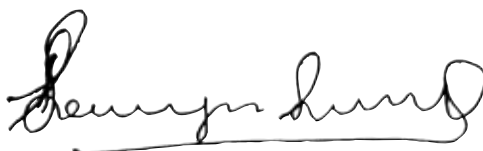
After I was put off by iOS (read below), I had to get a nano to micro-SIM adapter, but absent-mindedly pushed the adapter, sans SIM, into the Z30. When I yanked it out again, I bent and broke some SIM contact pins and had to send it off for repair.

As for iOS: after the excitement of the screen died down, I realised that using email is a chore on iOS (comparatively), as is double-tapping that silly hardware button to jump to another open app. For someone who switches between apps constantly – most commonly four email accounts, WhatsApp, Facebook, phone app and contacts, SMS, browser and Tapatalk – iOS just seemed too clunky. If I'd never used BlackBerry 10, maybe I wouldn't know any better, but I do. I like the Hub and the swipe-up-to-change-app fluid gesture of BlackBerry 10.

I also suspect that had I actually bought the 6 Plus with hard earned money after going ga-ga over the screen, I might fear ridicule and just force myself to get used to the iOS way of doing things (for, well, 60K+ reasons!).

Call me an iDiot if you want, but if BlackBerry (instead of experimenting with models such as the Passport) would just make a phone physically identical to the iPhone 6 Plus, I'd happily throw my money at it! For now, I still love iOS for a tablet OS and BlackBerry for a phone. Sorry Fandroids, although I do love the freedom to tinker with APKs, I can also do that on a BlackBerry with all non-Google-made apps. 

Please send hate mail to robert@digit.in with the subject "iDiot"




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